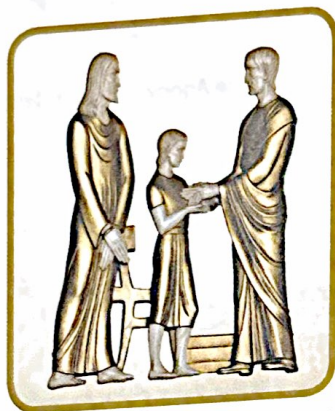


Stations of the Cross

The 14 Stations of the Cross represent events from Jesus' Passion and Death. At each station, we use our senses and our imagination to reflect prayerfully on Jesus' suffering, Death, and Resurrection.



1 **Jesus Is Condemned to Death.**
Pontius Pilate condemns Jesus to death.



2 **Jesus Takes Up the Cross.**
Jesus willingly accepts and patiently bears the cross.



3 **Jesus Falls the First Time.**
Weakened by torments and loss of blood, Jesus falls beneath the cross.



4 **Jesus Meets His Sorrowful Mother.**
Jesus meets his mother, Mary, who is filled with grief.



5 **Simon of Cyrene Helps Jesus Carry the Cross.**
Soldiers force Simon of Cyrene to carry the cross.



6 **Veronica Wipes the Face of Jesus.**
Veronica steps through the crowd to wipe the face of Jesus.



7 Jesus Falls the Second Time.

Jesus falls beneath the weight of the cross a second time.



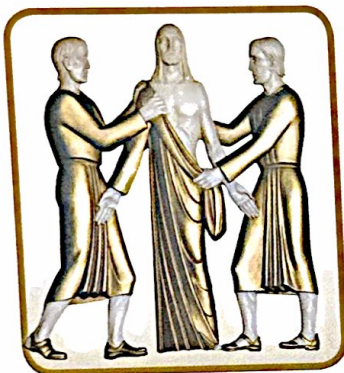
8 Jesus Meets the Women of Jerusalem.

Jesus tells the women not to weep for him but for themselves and for their children.



9 Jesus Falls the Third Time.

Weakened almost to the point of death, Jesus falls a third time.



10 Jesus Is Stripped of His Garments.

The soldiers strip Jesus of his garments, treating him as a common criminal.



11 Jesus Is Nailed to the Cross.

Jesus' hands and feet are nailed to the cross.



12 Jesus Dies on the Cross.

After suffering greatly on the cross, Jesus bows his head and dies.



13 Jesus Is Taken Down from the Cross.

The lifeless body of Jesus is tenderly placed in the arms of Mary, his mother.



14 Jesus Is Laid in the Tomb.

Jesus' disciples place his body in the tomb.

A closing prayer, sometimes in the form of a 15th station, invites us to reflect on the Resurrection of Jesus.

Christian Living

SESSION

19



GOD'S WORD

Read and listen to
Mark 10:43–45.

Jesus taught his disciples that the ones who serve God and help other people are the true leaders among them. The ones who will be “first” don’t act as if they are more important than others. When we help others, we know that they are also helping us. When we treat others with kindness and respect, we are acting as Jesus would want us to act.

Jesus invites us to respect, help, and care for one another. Each of us has gifts to give the world. These gifts help us show our love and gratitude to God. We use our gifts to serve God and others. To be great, we serve. To be first, we put others before ourselves.



Soup for the Masses on a Winter Day, Paris, Norbert Goeneutte, 1881



Prayer

Jesus, remind me that to be great and first is not important. Remind me that what is important is that you are with me. What is important is for me to serve what you have created through God the Father.

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UNDERSTANDING SCRIPTURE

The disciples James and John wanted to be powerful by sitting close to Jesus, but Jesus told them not to think about their status. He told them that only God can determine who receives honor in his kingdom. Jesus called all the disciples to him. He said that greatness comes from serving others, not from considering oneself superior. He said that greatness and status result from giving up both in order to serve. In Matthew, Jesus says, “But many who are first will be last, and the last will be first” and “Thus, the last will be first, and the first will be last.”

IF TIME ALLOWS

Scripture BLM: Mark 10:43–45

Have children complete Scripture BLM 19 to gain a better understanding of the passage.



SESSION 19

OUTCOMES

- ▶ Recognize how Jesus wants us to understand “great” and “first.”
- ▶ Describe some vocations.
- ▶ Explain that we all have received different gifts from God.
- ▶ Define *Holy Orders*, *Matrimony*, and *vocation*.

1 Open Your Heart

Invite children to quiet themselves and prepare to hear sacred Scripture.

2 Proclaim God's Word

Take the Bible from the Prayer Center. Read Mark 10:43–45. Then say: ***The Gospel of the Lord.*** Invite children to respond *Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.*

3 The Word Alive

Read aloud the paragraphs. Ask: ***What does it mean to be “great” and “first”?*** (successful, powerful, important) ***How would it feel to give your place in line to another person?*** (good, by showing others that they are also important) ***How can you be “great” and “first”?*** (by serving God and those in need)



Prayer

Say: ***Let's ask for Jesus' help in seeing how we can serve. Pray the prayer with me.*** Conclude the prayer by praying *Amen.*



If appropriate and feasible, have children scan the code on page 155.

Sacrament of Matrimony

The Holy Spirit calls some men and women to be married. They agree to live in faithful love in the Sacrament of **Matrimony**. Other people choose to remain single. Single people serve God in their lives and in the work they do in the world. No matter what our vocation in life may be, God calls each of us to his service.

ACTIVITY: Your Vocation

Have you imagined what your vocation might be as an adult? Write how you could share God's love through your choice.

Answers will vary.



Meet a Saint

Saint Andrew Kim was the first priest born in Korea. Andrew's parents had become Catholics at the time of his birth. When he was 15 years old, he went to a seminary in southern China. He returned to Korea and began spreading God's Word as a priest. Years later he and many others were martyred for their faith. The Feast of Saint Andrew Kim Taegon and his companions is September 20.

Have a volunteer read aloud the heading and first paragraph. Ask:

When men and women agree to live in faithful love, what sacrament do they receive? (the Sacrament of Matrimony) Have children find the word *Matrimony* in the Glossary and read its definition. Direct children's attention to the *Finding God* poster. The Seven Sacraments. Say:

Matrimony is one of two sacraments that bless a vocation. It blesses all those who choose to marry.

ACTIVITY

Ask a volunteer to read aloud Your Vocation. Have children share what their future vocations might be and why. Ask how this relates to their gifts and how they might serve God and others. Ask children to think of symbols for their gifts, such as music notes or a firefighter's helmet. Have children draw the symbols on paper and set these aside to use during prayer.

Meet a Saint

Read the story of Saint Andrew Kim Taegon [TAY gahn]. Ask: **What does martyr mean?** (a person who accepts death rather than deny his or her faith)

Ask: **What was Andrew Kim Taegon's vocation?** (priest) Point to the picture.

Say: **Saint Andrew is wearing a red stole. A stole is a sign of priestly office.**

Close

Use the following page and the Art Print easel to teach Art Print 19: *A Sunny Corner*.



Activity BLM: Gifts from God
Have children complete Activity BLM 19 to draw pictures of their gifts from God.



IF TIME ALLOWS

1 Begin

Ask children to name a talent they have. Encourage them to broaden their view of a "talent." For example, they may have interpersonal talents, such as being a good listener or being cheerful. Say: **Each of us has received different gifts, and we are each called to share these gifts in different ways.**

2 Connect

Display the *Finding God* poster. The Seven Sacraments. To begin, have children find the terms *vocation* and *Holy Orders* in the Glossary and read aloud the heading and the first paragraph. Ask: **With whom does the Holy Spirit want us to share our gifts? (Church and community)** Ask: **What is the way we are called to share our gifts? (our vocation)**

Ask children to tell about anyone they know who belongs to a religious order. Invite volunteers to read aloud the Sacrament of Holy Orders. Point to the Sacrament of Holy Orders on the poster. Invite responses to the question at the end of the paragraph. (Answers might include Saint Katharine Drexel and Saints Benedict and Scholastica.)

Reading God's Word

Have a volunteer read aloud the passage. Ask children what it means. (Each gift is a sign of God's grace. We use the gifts God gives us to serve one another.)

Family and Community

EXPLORE

The Call to Share Our Gifts

God gives us many wonderful gifts. These are our special talents and abilities. The Holy Spirit calls us to share our gifts with the Church and community. We share Jesus' mission and act in his name. Each of us is called to a *vocation*, or way of life. *Vocation* comes from a word meaning "to call."

Sacrament of Holy Orders

Some men become priests. They serve the Church in the name of Christ. Other men serve the Church by being ordained as deacons. Both priests and deacons celebrate the Sacrament of Holy Orders. The sacrament includes the laying on

of hands by a bishop. While laying on hands, the bishop prays for God to send the graces of the Holy Spirit needed by the ordained to serve and be a shepherd to the faithful.

Outside of the sacrament, some men and women publicly dedicate their lives to serving God and the Church. Can you name someone you have learned about in this book who has done this?

Reading God's Word

As each one has received a gift, use it to serve one another as good stewards of God's varied grace.

1 Peter 4:10



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IF TIME ALLOWS

Service: Thank-You Cards

Have children select someone to thank for using his or her vocation to help others. The person thanked could be a priest, deacon, brother or sister in a religious order, a bishop, or the pope. Provide cardstock and art supplies to make thank-you notes. Have children sign only their first names. Collect the cards and send them to the selected recipients.

Solidarity

FOR THE CATECHIST

READ about a calling.



1 Begin

Display the Art Print easel open to Art Print 19. Briefly introduce and discuss the artwork, using information from About the Artist and Art•i•facts. Ask: **What are the children doing?** (peeling fruit and/or potatoes; the boy may also be babysitting his younger sister) **Why might they be doing this?** (They are probably helping prepare a meal.) **What gifts are they putting into service?** (their eyesight, their hands, their helpfulness)

2 Connect

Read aloud the introduction and discuss the question. Ask volunteers to read aloud *Many Gifts, One Spirit*. Ask: **Why does Paul point out differences in gifts and types of work we do?** (so we know there are many ways to serve God) **Where does the variety of things we can do come from?** (one Holy Spirit)

ACTIVITY Read aloud *Working Together*. Give children time to fill in the blanks. Then ask volunteers to share their answers.

✝ *Work and Workers*

3 Close

Invite children to reflect on the artwork and pray a silent prayer thanking God for their gifts.

Link to Liturgy

Ask a volunteer to read aloud the feature. Say: **Next time you go to Mass, listen to and think about the words of the Dismissal.**

Art Print 19 shows a brother and sister helping prepare for their meal. How do you use your gifts to help others?

Many Gifts, One Spirit

Saint Paul wrote to his friends, explaining how they can use their gifts to help others. He wrote that there are many different kinds of spiritual gifts. They all come from the same Holy Spirit. There are different ways to serve the same God. We each do different work, but the same God helps us. The Holy Spirit works in each of us to help us do things for the good of others. Some of us can speak with knowledge and teach others. Some can heal sick people. The Holy Spirit decides which gifts to give us and calls us to use them.



ACTIVITY: Working Together

Think of work you have done using your gifts to help someone in your life. Choose four people and write something you can do to serve them.

mother **Answers will vary.**
father _____
sister/brother _____
teacher _____
neighbor _____
friend _____



Link to Liturgy

At Dismissal at the end of Mass, the priest or deacon sends us with instructions for spreading God's love and peace.

IF TIME ALLOWS

Art Studio: We All Work

Distribute art supplies. Invite children to choose one of their responses to *Working Together* and illustrate it.

✝ *Work and Workers*



Using the Art Print

For additional activities and prayer opportunities, see the Art Print back.

Reflect on God's Gifts to You

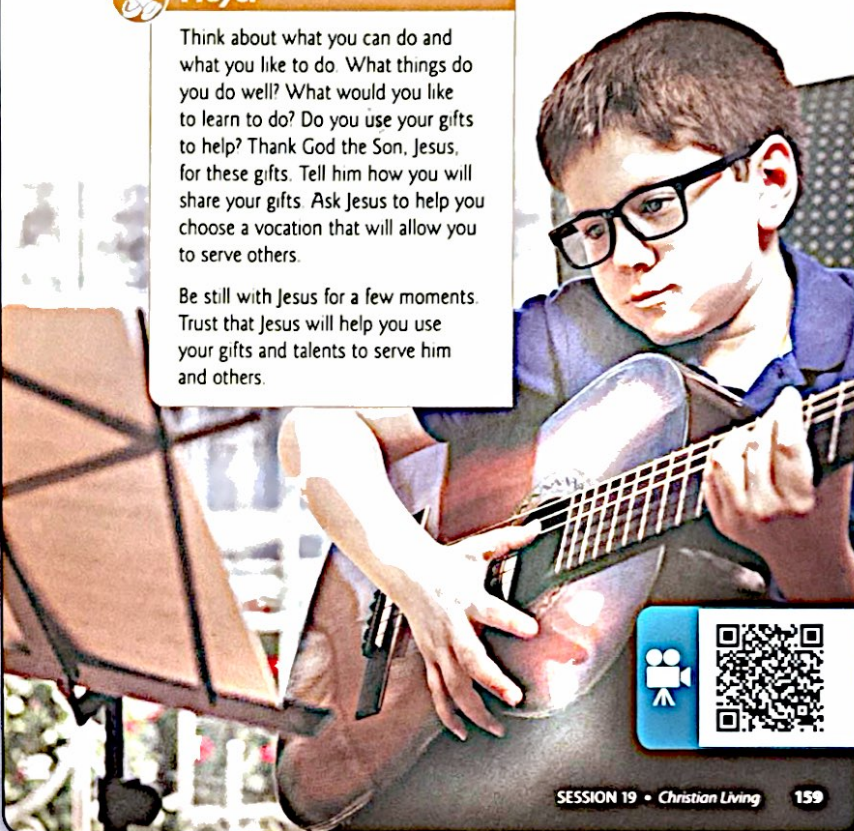
Our gifts from God include things we like to do and things we do well. Spend some time talking with God about his gifts to you. Ask for his guidance in using them. In the quiet of your heart, pray the imaginative prayer below.



Prayer

Think about what you can do and what you like to do. What things do you do well? What would you like to learn to do? Do you use your gifts to help? Thank God the Son, Jesus, for these gifts. Tell him how you will share your gifts. Ask Jesus to help you choose a vocation that will allow you to serve others.

Be still with Jesus for a few moments. Trust that Jesus will help you use your gifts and talents to serve him and others.



REFLECT



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IF TIME ALLOWS

Scripture Prayer Service BLM:

Mark 10:43–45

For an optional prayer service focused on this session's opening Scripture passage, refer to Scripture Prayer Service BLM 19.



Pray Again

If you used the recorded guided reflection, you might use this prayer page during another session.

COACHING CHILDREN TO PRAY

After the close of the prayer, offer suggestions built on the last sentence of the prayer, encouraging children to thank Jesus for the gift of their talents and for his guidance in using them to help others.

Choose an approach for prayer.

Recorded Guided Reflection



Prepare Listen in advance to the recorded guided reflection "Our Gifts from God." Decide

if you will use the recording or lead the reflection yourself. If you choose to lead, listen to the recording again, following the script [pages T-314–T-315]. Use the script or adapt it as you wish.



Prayer

During the session, play the recording or lead using the script, joining children in reflective prayer. If you use the script, play reflective music in the background.

APPROACH 1

Children's Prayer

Prepare Pray the prayer on page 159 in advance to become familiar with it.



Prayer

Say: *Let us reflect on the gifts the Holy Spirit has given to us and how we can use our talents to serve God.*

Have children sit in a circle. Say: *Now close your eyes. We are ready to begin.*

Read aloud the first paragraph, pausing after each question. Then read aloud the reflection. Lead children in praying the Sign of the Cross. Say: *Now let's learn how we can use our talents to serve others.*



If appropriate and feasible, have children scan the code on page 159.

Living My Faith

Faith Summary

God has given us talents and abilities, which are gifts from him. The Holy Spirit calls us to share these gifts. Each of us is called to a way of life that will help us share God's love.

Words I Learned

Holy Orders Matrimony vocation

Ways of Being Like Jesus

Jesus served others. Share your gifts and talents with someone who is struggling or could use your friendship.

ACTIVITY: My Gifts and Talents

In the box below, draw a symbol showing something you do well or are interested in. It can be something you use when you practice your talent or interest, such as a tennis racket or a pencil. On the lines next to your drawing, describe how you could use your gift to help others.

Jesus, thank you for the abilities you have given me. Guide me to the way of life you have planned for me.

Prayer



Answers will vary.

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IF TIME ALLOWS

ACCESS an Interactive Session Review.



INCLUSION

Autism Spectrum

As an aid to completing the activity on page 161, use social stories to help children think about their abilities and interests. Social stories are stories that have been authored according to specific criteria for children with autism. Examples are available online, and compilations are available in print.

1 Begin

Faith Summary Read aloud this section and ask: *Who calls us to share our gifts? (the Holy Spirit) What are we called to do with these gifts? (use them to share God's love)*

2 Connect

Words I Learned Ask: *What do Holy Orders and Matrimony have in common? (Both are sacraments and vocations that serve God and others.)* Ask volunteers to find the terms in the Glossary and read the definitions.

Ways of Being Like Jesus

After reading aloud this section, ask children for specific suggestions for using their gifts to help others, such as helping a classmate with homework for a subject they know well.

ACTIVITY

Read aloud the directions. Give children time to think and to draw their pictures. This can be a picture of themselves doing that activity or something else that represents the activity. Also allow them time to write how they can serve others by doing what they do well. Then have volunteers share and discuss with the class what they have drawn and written.

Prayer

Say: *Let's pray and thank Jesus for helping us use our gifts to serve others. Join me in praying aloud.* After praying, ask children to thank God the Father silently for the gifts he has given his people. Conclude by praying *Amen.*

1 Begin

Say: We have talked about the different gifts that God has given each of us. As you grow, what kinds of jobs can you do with your gifts? (Answers will vary.) How can you offer your gifts and talents to help people in your Church and community? (Answers will vary.) Discuss different jobs one can do to serve.

2 Connect

Read aloud the heading. Have a volunteer read aloud the first paragraph. Give children a few minutes to think about how their talents translate into service.

ACTIVITY Read aloud *We Offer God Our Gifts and Talents*. Make

sure children understand the

directions. Remind children they can

find the answers in the previous pages of the session. When all children have

finished, check the answers together. Invite children to share their answers

to the last sentence.

3 Close

Say: Let us ask God to guide us in using our gifts and talents to help those

around us. Give children a moment to

pray. Conclude by praying aloud the

Sign of the Cross.

What Will I Do?

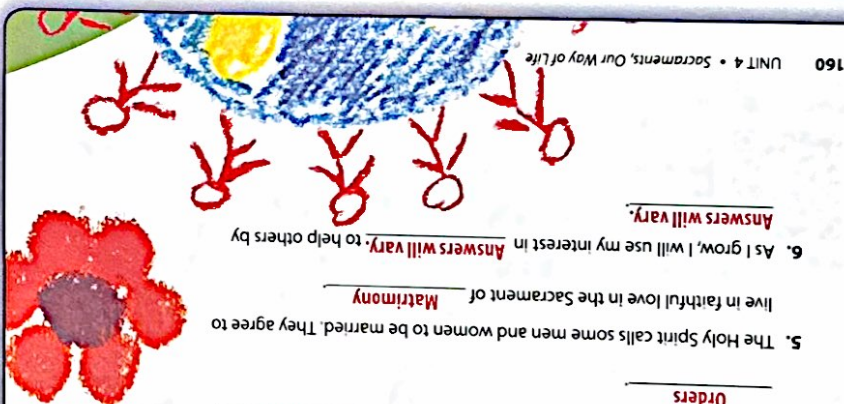
God has given each of us gifts and talents. We can use them for the glory of God—to help others and make our world better for everyone. Think about your own gifts and talents and how you can use them in whatever you choose to do.



ACTIVITY: We Offer God Our Gifts and Talents

Complete the sentences below. Look back in this session for help.

1. God gives us gifts of things we do well or like to do.
2. The Holy Spirit calls us to share our gifts with the Church and the community.
3. We are each called to a vocation or way of life.
4. Men who become priests celebrate the Sacrament of Holy Orders.
5. The Holy Spirit calls some men and women to be married. They agree to live in faithful love in the Sacrament of Matrimony.
6. As I grow, I will use my interest in Answers will vary. to help others by Answers will vary.



IF TIME ALLOWS

Symbols of Service

Have each child draw and cut out from construction paper a symbol of a way to serve. For example, a hammer could represent building houses for people without housing. Using multicolored index cards, have each child write a short explanation of how his or her symbol represents service. Add children's work to a bulletin board or poster entitled "Serving God and His Creation."

3 Go in Peace

Invite children to share this tear-out page with their families. To close this session, say: **God loves us and wants us to help one another. Remember to use your gifts to serve God and help others.**

With My Family

Scripture Together

As the time of his Death approached, Jesus called on his followers to serve God.

As a family, read **John 12:24–26** to find out what Jesus told his followers before his Death. When you have finished, discuss the Scripture. Use the questions below to guide you:

- What does Jesus say must happen to the grain of wheat in order for it to grow?
- Describe a time when letting go of thoughts of yourself led you to help others.
- How do you as a family grow when you listen to Jesus' words and share your gifts with one another?



Family Prayer

Pray together:

Dear God, thank you for your gifts of things we take joy in doing. Help us serve you, our family, and others with those gifts. Amen.

Faith on the Go

Ask one another: *Why do we feel better when we use things we do well and are learning to do to help others?*

ACTIVITY: Our Gifts and Talents

Have each family member name a gift or talent another family member has. Describe how that person's gift or talent enriches your family.



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ASSESSMENT

Session Assessment Option

A session assessment can be found at www.findinggod.com.

PLAN AHEAD: Get Ready for Session 20

Consult the catechist preparation pages to prepare for Session 20 and determine any materials you will need.